

AZ COALITION

Comms Hub

Creating & Managing Storms

An addendum to the User Manual, covering Storm Chasers Hub in full detail

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What This Addendum Covers

The main User Manual's Storm Chasers Hub section covers the big picture: what a Storm is and when to use one. This addendum goes deeper — the actual step-by-step of creating a storm, building out its Posts, moving it through review, and getting it in front of people.

A “Storm” is a coordinated, multi-platform campaign — a container that holds one or more finished Posts (a video or graphics plus matching text for all six platforms), built around a candidate, an issue, a race, or the coalition as a whole. It's the most advanced tool in the Comms Hub, and it's where individual messages come together into a shared, staff-coordinated push.

1 — One Page for Everyone

Storm Chasers Hub is a single page for the whole coalition, not separate tools for staff and members. Managers and Administrators land on Manager View — the full list of storms with status controls. A Manager View / User View toggle lets staff preview exactly what a member sees.

- Members always see User View: browsing active storms, plus a “My Storms” section for anything they've personally started.
- Managers and Administrators can flip into User View any time to check what a member's experience actually looks like.

2 — Storm Status Lifecycle

Every storm moves through four statuses. Understanding this flow is the key to understanding who can do what, and when.

Status	Meaning	Who can move it here
Draft	Being built, not yet visible to the coalition at large. Every storm starts here.	Anyone
Pending Review	A member has submitted their draft for staff review.	The storm's own creator
Active	Live and visible to members for downloading and posting.	Managers & Administrators
Archived	No longer active.	Managers & Administrators

Tip

A storm always starts in Draft, no matter who creates it or what gets typed into the form — there's no way to skip straight to Active.

3 — Creating a New Storm

Click “+ New Storm” from Storm Chasers Hub and fill in the storm's container fields — this is the information every Post inside it will draw on.

New Storm

Title *

Brief Summary

Shown in the storm list — keep it to one sentence.

Longer Description

Background, goals, talking points, anything members should know before posting...

Full context and instructions — shown when a storm is opened.

Subject Type

Coalition-wide

Hashtag

Optional. No # needed — appended automatically when a member copies a post.

Urgency

1 Alarm

2 Alarm

3 Alarm — Urgent

Start Date & Time

Expiration Date & Time

Cancel

Create Storm

Mockup: the New Storm form

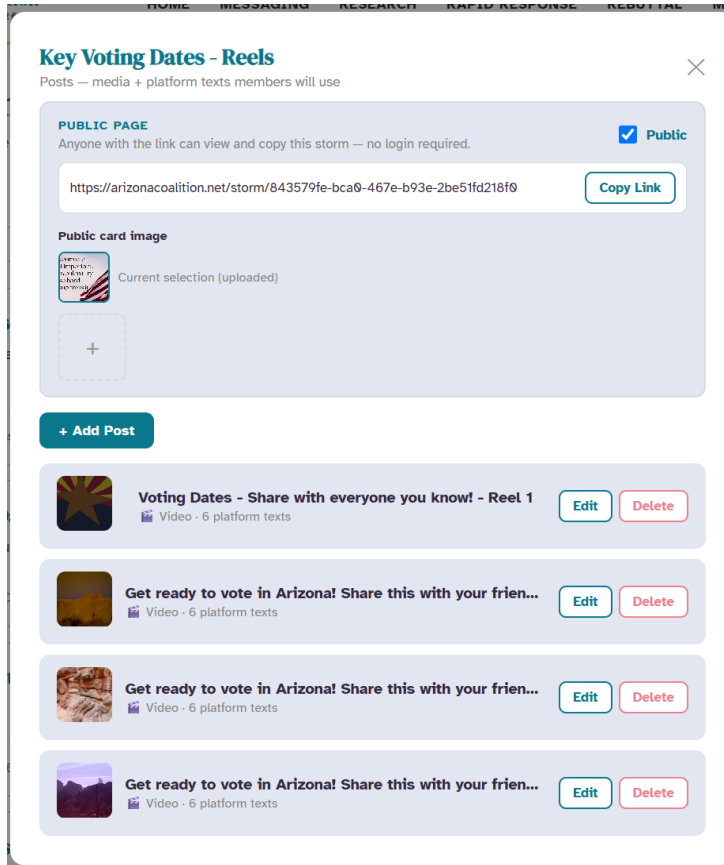
Fields to fill in

- Title, a short summary, and a longer description.
- A hashtag, entered without the # — it's added automatically when someone copies a post.
- Subject Type & Name — Candidate, Issue/Topic, Race/District, or Coalition-wide.
- Urgency — a 1–3 alarm rating, shown as a bell icon.
- A start date/time and an expiration date/time.

Once you click Create Storm, it exists in Draft — visible only to you (and to staff in Manager View) until it's submitted and moved further along.

4 — Building Posts Inside a Storm

Once a storm exists, open Manage Storm → Storm Posts to add individual Posts. Each Post can hold one video or several graphics, plus text for each of the six platforms — each with its own character limit shown live as you type.



Message Machine.

What you can do with each platform's text

- **Generate** — write a first draft using the same AI writing tool that powers Message Machine, grounded in the storm's own title, subject, summary, and description.
- **Rephrase** — rework existing text without starting over.
- **Lock (Managers/Administrators only)** — locks a platform's text so it can no longer be edited or rephrased; locked fields show a “Locked by staff” tag.

Other ways Posts get built

- **Push-to-Storm from Message Machine (Managers/Administrators only)** — send a finished Message Machine post straight into an existing storm, or start a brand-new storm from it.
- **Media (video or graphics)** is always added manually by staff — it's never included automatically by a push from

Remember

Storm posts don't carry Message Machine's Mode, Audience, Voice, Style, or Tone settings unless they arrived via Push-to-Storm — a post built natively inside Storms is grounded only in the storm's own title, subject, summary, and description.

5 — Publishing & Sharing

Once Posts are built out and the storm has moved to Active, there are two ways people actually get the content out.

Direct download or copy

- Anyone with access can download or copy each platform's text and media to post it themselves, from their own accounts.

Public storm pages

- Some storms have a public storm page — a shareable link anyone can view without logging in, useful for supporters posting outside the coalition's own accounts.
- The public page shows only safe fields: title, summary, card image, and each Post's title/media/platform text — never the longer description, hashtag, subject type, alarm level, dates, or staff names.
- Public Storms Directory lists every currently public, active, unexpired storm as browsable cards, so volunteers don't need individual links handed to them one at a time.

Regenerate on a published post

A Regenerate button lets anyone — including a public visitor — get a fresh alternate take on an already-published post's text, without ever touching what's actually saved and shown to others.

- Always ephemeral — regenerating never overwrites the stored post text; the result appears in its own dismissible block with Copy and “Revert to original.”
- Rate-limited to keep it from being abused: 20 times a day per visitor, 200 times a day per storm, 1,000 times a day sitewide.
- Staff have a manual kill-switch for Regenerate, no deploy needed, if it's ever misused.

Appendix: Storm Permissions at a Glance

A quick-reference version of everything above, focused specifically on Storms.

Action	Member	Manager	Administrator
Create a new storm (always starts as Draft)	✓	✓	✓
Edit their own Draft storm	✓	✓	✓
Submit their own storm for review	✓	✓	✓
Manage Posts on a storm they created	✓	✓	✓
Manage Posts on any storm	–	✓	✓
Move a storm into or out of Active	–	✓	✓
Lock a platform's text on a Post	–	✓	✓
Push a Message Machine post into a storm	–	✓	✓
Archive a storm	–	✓	✓
Permanently delete a storm	–	–	✓